MERIDIAN TALENT PARTNERS OOD

FY2026 Strategic Plan & Growth Priorities

Prepared by CEO | January 2026 | Board Document — STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL

CEO Foreword

FY2025 was a good year for Meridian. Revenue grew 11.6% to €4.8M, our executive search practice grew 25.7%, and we closed the year with 7.1% net margins — our best result since we were founded. But I am not writing this as a celebration. I am writing it as a warning.

The environment we operate in is changing faster than we are. Large international staffing groups are entering our markets with aggressive pricing. Our best client contacts are building capable in-house TA teams. And candidates — particularly in technology — have more direct routes to employers than ever before. The business model that got us to €4.8M is not the business model that will get us to €8M or €10M.

FY2026 must be the year we answer the question: what does Meridian look like at the next level? This plan is built on three pillars: Speed (close the time-to-fill gap), Scale (launch a real RPO product), and Smarter Delivery (use technology and AI to do more with the team we have). — Dimitar Popov, CEO

Strategic Priorities FY2026

Priority	Headline Goal	Key Initiatives	Success Metric	Owner
1. Speed: Reduce Time-to-Fill	Reduce average TTF from 38 to 28 days by Q4 2026	— Evaluate and implement AI-assisted sourcing tool by Q3 2026 — Revitalise candidate database (Vincere migration + cleansing) — Standardise sourcing process and brief template adoption	≤28 days avg TTF all permanent roles by Oct 2026	Sr Partner Ivanov + Ops Director Mihailova
2. Scale: Launch RPO Service Line	Formalise RPO product and sign 2 new RPO contracts by Q4 2026	— Define RPO service tiers (Embedded, Hybrid, Full) with SLAs and pricing — Develop RPO commercial model and contract template — Expand DataNexus Warsaw to full RPO contract — Target 2 new RPO clients by Q4 2026	2 signed RPO contracts; RPO revenue >€400K in FY2026	RPO Manager Nowak + CEO
3. Smarter Delivery: AI & Automation	Reduce consultant admin burden by 30%; improve client satisfaction to 4.2/5	— Complete AI Value Blueprint engagement (AI Assist BG) by June 2026 — Implement top 2–3 AI recommendations from Blueprint by Q4 — Standardise client reporting with automated ATS updates — Implement CV formatting automation	Client comms satisfaction ≥4.0 by Q4 2026; CV formatting ≤30 min per candidate	Ops Director Mihailova
4. Executive Search Growth	Grow executive search to 30% of revenue (from 18%) by FY2026 end	— Invest in exec search brand positioning (events, thought leadership) — Add 2 senior consultants in exec search practice H2 2026 — Develop structured exec assessment methodology	Exec search = 30% of FY2026 revenue; avg fee ≥€26,000	Sr Partner Georgieva

Financial Targets FY2026

Metric	FY2025 Actual	FY2026 Target	Notes
Total Revenue	€4,823,400	€6,000,000	25% growth; exec search mix + RPO expansion
Executive Search Revenue	€868,200 (18%)	€1,800,000 (30%)	Requires both volume and average fee growth
RPO Revenue	€241,000 (5%)	€600,000+ (10%)	2 new RPO contracts + DataNexus expansion
EBITDA Margin	8.7%	10.0%+	Scale benefits + reduced admin burden from AI tools
Revenue per Delivery FTE	€114,843	€125,000	Efficiency improvement + selective new hiring
Average Time-to-Fill	38 days	28 days	Primary operational target for FY2026
Client Satisfaction (overall)	3.83 / 5.0	4.20 / 5.0	Communication and transparency improvement is critical
Net Headcount Additions	—	+6 to +8	Primarily H2 2026; conditional on RPO contract wins

Key Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Vincere migration disrupts operations beyond July 2026	Medium	High	Dedicated Ops Director time; external Vincere consultant engaged from June 2026
Executive search growth slower than targeted	Medium	High	Investment in exec brand + 2 senior hires; exec pipeline reviewed monthly by CEO and Georgieva
AI tools fail to deliver sourcing improvement	Low–Medium	Medium	Blueprint engagement first; pilot before full rollout; clear success metrics defined per tool
Key consultant departure (Ivanov or Georgieva)	Low	Very High	Retention incentive plan under discussion; succession mapping for both Partners underway
New EU AI Act requirements affect candidate profiling	Low	Medium	Legal review of AI tools before deployment; no automated candidate scoring without human review
RPO pricing pressure from larger competitors	Medium	Medium	Differentiate on embedded quality + CEE specialist knowledge; do not compete on price

This document is the internal strategic plan for FY2026, approved by the Meridian Board in January 2026. Subject to quarterly review. Updated forecasts presented at the Q2 2026 board review (July 2026). Distribution: Board members and Management Team only.